MZUZU UNIVERSITY
FACULTY OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES
DEPARTMENT OF COMMUNICATION STUDIES

1. **Program** : Bachelors and Diploma programmes
2. **Subject** : Communication Studies
3. **Level of Study** : One
4. **Course Title** : Communication Skills I
5. **Course Code** : COMM 1101
6. **Duration** : 16 Weeks
7. **Presented to** : Faculty of Humanities & Social Science
8. **Presented by** : Department of Communication Studies
9. **Lecture Hours Per Week** : 4
10. **Tutorial Hours Per Week** : 1
11. **Practical Hours Per Week** : None
12. **Students Independent Learning Hours** : 8
13. **Total Course Credits** : 10

14. **Assessment Methods (Outline, Continuous and Final Examination Techniques)** : Examinations, Assignments, Presentations, Group work evaluations and Portfolios

15. **Assessment Weighting** : 40% Continuous Assessment
60% End of Semester Examinations

16. **Aim(s) of the Course** : To equip students with appropriate language and communication skills necessary for academic demands.

17. **Learning Outcomes** : By the end of this course students should be able to:

(i) Read different texts effectively.
(ii) Produce effective summaries from lectures and reading tasks.
(iii) Effectively manage time and other academic resources.
(iv) Write different types of academic papers.
(v) Write various forms of official reports

18. **Topics of Study** : (i) Introduction to Communication

a. Definition of communication
b. Process of communication
c. Basic theories of communication

(ii) Listening Skills

a. Definition of Listening
b. Rational for Listening
c. The process of Listening
d. Barriers to Listening

e. Types of listening
f. Recognizing change of topic
g. Note taking and note making

(iii) Study Skills

a. Planning work
b. Organizing study resources
c. Budgeting study time
d. Principles of effective studying
e. Examination skills

(iv) Reading Skills

a. Definition of reading
b. Reading strategies
c. Understanding the structure of discourse in reading

(vi) Writing Essays

a. Definition
b. Planning
c. Structure of an essay
d. Types of essays

(vii) Referencing

a. Rationale for referencing
b. Using and acknowledging other people's ideas
c. Reference List and bibliography

(viii) Reports Writing

a. Definition
b. Rationale for writing reports
c. The nature of reports
d. Types of reports

19. **Prescribed Texts** :

Devito, Joseph A. (2003). *Human communication: The basic course. (9th Ed.).* New York: Pearson Education

Pearson Judy, Nelson Paul, Titsworth Scott, Harter Lynn (2013). *Human Communication*. *(5th Ed.).* New York: MacGraw Hill

21. Recommended Texts

Gibson, James W. & Hanna Michael (1999). *Introduction to Human communication*. New York:Wm. C. Brown Publishers.

Burns, Tom (2008). Essential Study Skills: *The complete guide to success at University. (2nd Ed.).* London: Sage Publications

Smith, Brenda (2007). *Breaking through college reading. (8th Ed.)*. New York: Pearson Education

This course outline was presented to senate on …… and approved on……